

Self Sabotage Protocol

You do not fail at the finish line by accident.

Self sabotage does not look like sabotage while it is happening. It looks like a sudden lack of motivation right before a launch. A fight picked right after things get good. A missed deadline on the one project that mattered most. The pattern is consistent enough to name. It shows up closest to success, not closest to failure, because success is what actually threatens the system.

DEVICE 01

Evidence vs Story

The story sounds like this. I just lost motivation. Things got busy. It was not the right time. I am lazy, that is just who I am.

1. List three times momentum on something important stalled right after real progress happened.
2. Mark the exact point where things were going well before the stall. Be specific about the timeline.
3. Write down what would have had to change in your life, relationships, or identity if that thing had actually succeeded.
4. Ask if any part of that change felt unfamiliar or unsafe, even if it also sounded good.

If the pattern clusters around moments right after things start working, it is not bad luck and it is not laziness. It is a system protecting a familiar identity from an unfamiliar outcome.

DEVICE 02

Body Scan

Recall a specific moment you sabotaged your own progress. Not the general idea, the specific memory. Go back into the body right before you made the choice that broke the momentum.

- Chest: a heaviness or flatness that arrived faster than the thought did
- Energy: a sudden drain, like the plug got pulled with no clear cause
- Hands: reaching for a distraction, a phone, a snack, anything else
- Face: a flush of something close to shame, arriving before any failure had actually occurred

The body downshifted before there was any real reason to. That timing is the evidence. Something in you clocked the outcome approaching and pulled the brake.

DEVICE 03

Mirror Check + Future Echo

Say this to the mirror, out loud. I did not fail by accident. Some part of me chose the familiar collapse over the unfamiliar win, because collapse I already know how to survive.

Fast forward five years. One version of you kept stopping one step from the finish, every time, and can list a decade of almos. Another version let the win happen and rebuilt an identity around it. Ask the first version one question. What was actually being protected by staying at almost, and was it worth the decade. Write the answer without softening it.

DEVICE 04

Cost Ledger

Put a real cost next to each line, not a feeling.

Cost of the pattern	What it actually took
Time	Years spent restarting projects from zero instead of building on progress
Money	Income or opportunities lost specifically at the point closest to payoff
Identity	How many times you have told this story as bad luck instead of as a pattern
Trust	Whether people who watched you stall repeatedly still bet on your follow through
Body	The exhaustion of running the same emotional cycle on a loop, from hope to collapse

Self sabotage is expensive precisely because it strikes closest to the return. The cost is not the failure. The cost is failing at the exact point where success was already paid for.

DEVICE 05

Lie Detector

Read each statement out loud. Check it against the timeline you built in Evidence vs Story. Most of these collapse once the timing of the stall is on paper in front of you.

I just was not motivated enough that time.	TRUE / FALSE
Success would not actually change anything about how people treat me.	TRUE / FALSE
This is just bad luck, it happens to everyone.	TRUE / FALSE

I do not deserve it as much as I think I do, so it makes sense it slipped.

TRUE / FALSE

If I actually succeeded, I would have to keep succeeding, and I could not.

TRUE / FALSE

BURKEONIS PROTOCOL SYSTEM / Case File 20 / EVIDENCE OVER STORY. PATTERNS OVER EXCUSES.